ENTERTAINER GUIDE TO CAREERS

Achieve your academic and career goals in a way that excites and stimulates you

16Personalities

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Introduction

Why Academic and Professional Development Matter to Entertainers

Professional development is an area that Entertainers are wise not to overlook. They don't always thrive in traditional academic settings or under the strict hierarchical structures that are common in many workplaces. On top of this, they tend to avoid blatant competition and are usually hesitant to expose themselves to potentially harsh criticism. As a consequence, they may unintentionally limit themselves both academically and in their chosen career.

For Entertainers, success is most likely to be found when they are encouraged and inspired to dive deep into their natural interests and passions. Finding their niche is crucial for their long-term satisfaction.

When they're fascinated by something, Entertainers plunge right in. A common mantra for them is, "Act first, ask questions later." This attitude represents a certain degree of impulsiveness, but it also hints at their drive to become masters at whatever it is they choose. Entertainers are resourceful and practical, traits that are enhanced when they are allowed a certain level of independence and self-determination to complete assignments or do the tasks that they need to do. In fact, when they're able to work under the right conditions, people with this personality type have true leadership potential. As natural communicators, they are at their best when they're working with other people and getting teammates excited and on board with just about any project that they stand behind.

No matter their academic or professional status, Entertainers thrive in supportive, positive environments where they are allowed to satisfy their cravings for variety and unpredictability. They have little patience for routine tasks or administrative planning and may wish to seek situations where these responsibilities can be delegated to others.

If Entertainers indulge their impulsivity to the extreme, then complex, long-term projects in the classroom or the workplace may suffer. Entertainers trust their instincts, and this trust in their ability to wing it can be taken too far. True mastery comes when they are able to balance their talent for improvisation with just enough structure and strategy to ensure progress toward their larger goals.

In these pages, we'll discuss how Entertainers can bring the full force of their strengths to their academic and professional pursuits – and how they can stay motivated and make progress toward those longer-term goals. Along the way, we'll cover how they can overcome challenges that people with their personality type often experience, including how to collaborate with people who don't see eye to eye with them and how to plan for the future without losing their spontaneous edge. When Entertainers harness their talents and work through their weaknesses, they often find that their observational skills, passionate energy, and quick thinking are exactly what they need to achieve their version of success.

Curious about the traits that make up your personality type and the theory behind them? You can learn more here.

Academic Path

Entertainers are naturally curious individuals who love learning new skills, especially those with practical benefits. They see education as an opportunity to engage themselves in experiences that result in gained knowledge and talents applicable to their interests and activities. Rock-climbing enthusiasts, for example, may pursue a degree in geology to learn more about the formations they're often in such close contact with.

Whatever path they take in their lives, Entertainers benefit from embracing their education and looking for learning opportunities. Whether they're studying medieval history in the classroom or teaching themselves how to build websites in their own home, these types profit from expanding their minds and increasing their skills.

The following paragraphs discuss the best ways for Entertainers to learn throughout their educational careers, and effective ways to improve upon their learning habits. This chapter also discusses the struggles Entertainers may face in the academic environment.

How Entertainers Learn

Balanced Learning Habits

Hands-On and Spontaneous Experiences

Hands-on mastery is the learning process that interests Entertainers most. They learn best in loose and unstructured environments with loose and unstructured curricula emphasizing the experiential. Entertainers respond to high levels of personal involvement in their

learning. They're usually restless in lecture hall settings – but, if they discover their niche, such as acting, for example, Entertainers can express their love of performing on a stage in an auditorium, a workshop, or even in a classroom.

Entertainers love to engage and perform in all ways, and they don't respond well to just sitting still and absorbing information. Give them something to do, and they participate. Allow them to express themselves in an amusing and compelling fashion, and they shine. But ask them to memorize and recall a historical timeline, and forget about it. They instantly lose interest.

These types also enjoy balanced coaching and feedback on their performances. Nobody likes criticism, but Entertainers are serious about mastering what interests them. They appreciate any observations that can help them do that. The optimal learning style for Entertainers is to see an instructor modeling a technique and then to perform the same technique immediately themselves. The ideal lesson is complete when they receive competent, constructive feedback on their performance.

Once Entertainers mature and gain mastery, they're likely to put their own spin on their work, but they understand they must first earn the privilege through instruction and practice. Once they gain a passion for something, they typically forego shortcuts. They would rather take the long route if it means someday executing their craft more skillfully – and that's usually Entertainers' central educational goal.

Unbalanced Learning Habits

Struggling with Traditional Structure

Sentinels are highly represented among teachers and school administrators. Their influence on the academic world is perceived by many as an important contribution to society, and it arguably is. However, that doesn't prevent their approach from causing some real problems for students with different learning styles like Entertainers.

Even the most grounded young Entertainers can struggle in an overly structured classroom. Unfortunately, many academic settings assume

all students gain knowledge in the same manner, and with Sentinels making up most of the population, traditional lectures and drills often rule in the classroom. But not all students react well to old-fashioned educational methods, and Entertainers are typically among them.

Entertainers are, seemingly, the "anti-Sentinels," but this doesn't necessarily mean they don't like Sentinels or are against them. Rather, it means they work in an almost opposite manner – their styles sometimes even clash. Sentinels are rules-based individuals who like to uphold tradition; they're orderly, think linearly, and favor the predictability of the conventional classroom. Entertainers aren't likely to learn much in such environments.

Rebalancing Learning Habits

Finding a Niche

Parents and instructors who want to reach Entertainers and engage them in the learning process must help them find their niche and provide them with opportunities to be spontaneous. They must give them something to work on independently, and offer them some freedom to express themselves.

Because they constantly scan for something novel, Entertainer students respond to instruction that features fresh boldness and spontaneity. They also like to reach decisions or conclusions in their own time, based on what they realize. Once they make a discovery, they may not wait around for others before they implement it. If Entertainers find themselves interested in something, taking action is almost always more important than just thinking about it. Instructors may need to fold a measure of flexibility into their lesson plans to accommodate these students.

It's important to remember that Entertainers tend to take just so much spoon-feeding before they go off on their own. When teachers must give instructions, Entertainers usually respond well to multisensory learning involving media and computers in novel ways. They also enjoy working with others and need a wide range of activities rich in personal involvement. For Entertainers, an effective activity is something physical; an exercise on paper won't likely hold their attention.

Entertainers in High School

Anyone who attended high school need not watch even one of the thousands of films about teenage angst to understand that high school's yards and hallways hold as many lessons as the classrooms. It's hard to talk about secondary education without discussing the social environment there. With this in mind, let's look at the blend of academic and social life that's likely to be Entertainers' high school experience.

Balanced High School Learning

Energetic and Sociable

Typically, Entertainers are popular among their classmates. They're fun and energetic, and they love drama and excitement. People with this personality type can be a bit gossipy, always broadcasting the latest social news – and in a highly entertaining fashion, at that. For high school students, what's not to like? Entertainers likely receive invitations to all the best parties and attend them just to see what's new.

In terms of learning, Entertainers at their best understand the necessity of attending classes and getting passing grades. They may struggle with traditional structure. But give them hands-on activities, such as building a birdhouse for shop class or participating in a model United Nations project for civics instead, and these lead to greater interest. Then, in turn, such interest inevitably leads to increased learning for these perceptive and practical students.

Extracurricular activities often pigeonhole modern teens into stereotypical niches; for example, the popular kids sign up for cheerleading, and the nerds join AV Club, and so on. For Entertainers, a club or group may represent more of a structured environment than they typically want. However, their love of people and social interaction may overrule that tendency. They are likely to do well in social organizations, drama clubs, sports teams, and other groups where they can shine as performers.

Unbalanced High School Learning

Out of Sync with the System

Entertainers often have a difficult time academically in high school. Their aversion to the structure of the average classroom might leave the impression they're troublemakers or even lacking in intelligence. Within the traditional system, it's easy to miss a genius of another type lurking below the surface in such students.

Unfortunately, too many teachers and parents don't understand this. They often view Entertainers as troublemakers out to steal the spotlight from the serious business of learning. When people with this personality type bring their expressive, spirited traits to an otherwise quiet and somber classroom, others may misinterpret the Entertainer persona as foolish. It would be a mistake to assume Entertainers are superficial and flighty, though. They notice everything that goes on around them and can be quite clever.

Handling educational differences is uncomplicated. Let other students memorize cold, hard facts or play with ideas, but make sure Entertainers have something practical and tangible to do. Point Entertainers toward music, drama, or other courses based on skill mastery and that offer expressive outlets. These often capable students just need the right fuel to ignite their intellectual fires.

However, if left to struggle with traditional education, Entertainers are likely to earn poor grades. They may experience painful emotional and psychological distress as a result. The constant message Entertainers may receive from their school environment is that they're out of sync with everyone else. Being popular among their peers may not be enough to suppress the sense that they don't quite fit the mold, and this may damage their self-esteem.

Rebalancing High School Learning

Relating Learning to Personal Interests

Many places are cutting or reducing their arts programs to tighten their budgets, and these cuts can be disappointing for many reasons.

They're especially painful for students who perform creatively. If available or reasonable, transferring to a high school specializing in the arts may be an appropriate option for some Entertainer students. They may feel more at home in such an environment, and they may finally receive a healthy dose of the affirming feedback that they sorely need.

There are also many accredited alternative schools that cater to students who feel out of place in traditional settings. They often allow students to create their own curriculum and explore their talents in their own way. These nontraditional schools could be great opportunities for Entertainers and might give these students opportunities not available elsewhere.

When they connect to an activity, skill, or artistic expression, Entertainers not only put in a great deal of effort to master it – they also often tolerate the passive lecture hall a little better. When Entertainer types can express themselves in ways true to their nature, they may find more patience for subjects that wouldn't normally fit their interests. They feel validated, making the traditional educational system easier to swallow and possibly even embrace as a necessary part of life.

Work or College?

While deciding whether to go to college involves many other reasons than personality types, they can have a role in the equation. Recently, most claimed college or university was the quickest path to success and security. Now, some of the same voices argue against higher education for everyone. They've witnessed some famous college dropouts succeeding on a grand scale – Steve Jobs and Bill Gates quickly come to mind. College may not be considered as necessary as it once was.

There's a niche for everyone and college is just one path to finding it. It's easy to see action-oriented Entertainers chomping at the bit to get out into the world as quickly as possible and start producing. However, their need to master their craft can be as insistent as their need to act. Many Entertainers find sales or customer service

fit their personalities well and neither demands a degree. However, some Entertainers need certification or concentrated training for the careers they choose, and, in those cases, higher education may be mandatory.

College would be unappealing to those Entertainers who imagine only lecture halls and books, but if they picture studios, workshops, and practice rooms instead, higher education may appeal to them. Although Entertainers could find apprenticeships in the nonacademic world, college provides a "ready-made" opportunity to learn from others. Of course, this primarily depends on choosing the right major at the right college.

Entertainers in College

Balanced Approach to College

Free to Find Their Way

Entertainers who attend a college or university likely feel as though the opportunity has set them free. No longer bound by the rules of high school life, some Entertainers may find an educational model that fits their style of learning at last. Add the fact that family and parents have less input into the decisions of this independent type, and college offers Entertainers a greater chance to be themselves.

Entertainers' college course choices are likely similar to the subjects they pursued as electives in high school. Any of the performing arts are probably a primary interest for many Entertainer students. However, they shouldn't feel limited to the arts. Courses that lead to activity-based professions that require social skills are also likely to be a nice fit for these students.

Mature Entertainers may want to resist pressure from parents and guidance counselors to choose majors and courses they struggled with in high school. If Entertainers didn't embrace more abstract, theoretical coursework in high school, the chances aren't any better for them doing so in college. Doing the same thing and expecting different results rarely works.

Unbalanced Approach to College

Too Focused on Enjoying the Moment

Some think the purpose of higher education is solely concerned with getting the tools to make a good living. Most Entertainers, however, reject this as the primary reason to get a degree. Convinced that their passion can always see them through, mastery and creativity are the primary motivators for typical Entertainers. They emphasize picking up skills they can use in the present. The future holds only a casual interest for them because they're too practical about the here and now to worry too much about tomorrow.

Like most young people, they delight in the autonomy college offers, and some students even choose their universities based on the school's distance from home.

Entertainers typically fit nicely into campus party life, and it may be a motive to attend college. Their thirst for novelty and outgoing nature may lead them to one sort of revelry followed closely by another. Some Entertainers must exercise caution, as this may become detrimental and result in their social life overshadowing their educational goals.

Rebalancing Their Approach to College

Learning to Deal with Difficulty

College is a time for Entertainers to consider and exploit their strengths and talents in real, concrete ways. Higher education provides students with an opportunity to customize their studies to match their interests more. Many Entertainers may have waited their whole lives for this.

However, life is rarely totally free of drudgery. Most colleges force students to take foundational, prerequisite courses many would rather not if given a choice. (Courses like "Introduction to Academic Writing" come to mind.) These classes often challenge Entertainers because they seem mundane to them. While some "test out" of these prerequisites, such foundational courses can offer tremendous benefits and may prove to be valuable, especially if Entertainers missed some basics in high school.

Learning to cope with dull or overly challenging classes is good disciplinary practice for Entertainers. It won't be the last time they run into necessary tasks they see as meaningless and boring. College can help Entertainers gain a degree of tolerance for that which is less than exciting and prepare them to approach the adult world in a more realistic manner.

Conclusion

In aiming for mastery and exploration that even the name "Entertainers" suggests, this personality type almost naturally embraces the role of lifelong learners in search of novelty and experiences. The initial trick in promoting learning for them won't involve directly motivating them or pushing them to improve basic skills, hoping their interest ignites after the fact. The trick is to help them find an interactive discipline that grabs and inspires them up front. On discovering such an interest, Entertainers are likely to throw themselves into the process.

Typically, when they find their niche, they look for ways to increase their skill levels on their own. With that focus in place, they may even find education, in a broader sense, more appealing. Entertainers can help themselves gain footing in their learning by understanding how education and training best works for them. Nurturing and indulging their tendency toward curiosity can be beneficial as they search for their passions. Exploring with a purposeful emphasis on discovery can help start them on their educational and, ultimately, their professional paths.

Professional Development

Even though others commonly call Entertainers "party people," their careers don't always reflect this sentiment. People with this personality type tend to be independent and resourceful, and these traits help them tremendously on the career ladder. Having an overview can be helpful in making career decisions and establishing the best path, and this chapter begins by exploring what empowers Entertainers to thrive in their vocations without falling prey to common pitfalls.

Novelty and Excitement

The most important trait shared by all Entertainers is a pronounced desire for excitement, stimulation, and novelty. People with this personality type seek new challenges, take pleasure in socializing, and always focus on the present, and some of the best careers for Entertainers emphasize these qualities. They're often among the most noted performers, photographers, event planners, and sales representatives.

Entertainers prefer working in more of a freeform manner. They loathe a strictly scheduled, structured, and monotonous grind. Meticulous data collection and analysis, theoretical writing, or a nine-to-five administrative job are akin to torture for Entertainers, and careers that fit those descriptions even remotely are likely to be unsuitable for this personality type. Instead, the best jobs are those in which they might express their love for novelty, beauty, and fresh experiences. For example, Entertainers might prefer careers in fashion or interior design, tourism, and trip planning, to name a few.

People-Focused

People are of interest to Entertainers, and this personality type knows how to make others happy, even in difficult situations. They can also be very resourceful when their help is needed. Human contact is crucial for these types, and almost all Entertainers base their career paths on this need. They often channel this preference into becoming counselors, social workers, personal coaches, consultants, and professionals in similar fields.

Very Specific Qualifications

The key things to remember in terms of Entertainer careers are:

- They need a lot of contact with other people, more so than any other personality type.
- Their thirst for new challenges is unquenchable.
- They must feel that others appreciate their work.

Despite being bold and flexible, Entertainers may face unwanted challenges in their careers if they choose the wrong path. Not every job welcomes their improvisational skills and independent ways. People with this personality type tend not to cope well when a workplace doesn't utilize their traits and talents, and it often boils down to picking a career that matches who they are.

Social and Exciting

Entertainers have a keen eye for detail and tend to give off a laid-back vibe. In addition, they typically are well-liked by their peers and excel in fields that reward social skills. People with this personality type aren't interested in building extensive systems or planning for contingency scenarios. They're largely unconcerned with security and stability. Mostly, they're interested in finding thrilling solutions or presenting engaging material that wins the admiration and gratitude of others.

Entertainers should focus on positioning themselves, so they're able to use their improvisation, influence, and problem-solving skills, while also retaining enough freedom to choose their own methods. This may be a challenging match for many employers. However, smart

managers notice quickly that it's useful and productive to have Entertainers on board.

Practical and Efficient

Being practical is a noteworthy trait common among Entertainers. They're likely to be very down-to-earth individuals, with an ability to remain levelheaded in even difficult situations. Instead of concentrating on theories and methods, which tend to prioritize plans and ideas above current events, Entertainers concentrate on the reality of the moment. They care little about superfluous information while they're making action-oriented decisions.

Entertainers should try to steer toward careers that reward practicality and efficiency. Perhaps even more importantly, they should look for roles within those careers that emphasize concrete, factual, and active tasks, rather than abstract matters such as ideas, brainstorming, diplomacy, or planning.

Beyond the Here and Now

While it's a strength to operate from "the here and now," it may be a mistake to neglect developing skills and expanding knowledge if given a chance. Many organizations offer training programs or subscriptions to professional magazines. Since Entertainers absorb knowledge readily, especially when related to social skills like psychology, they should indulge their curiosity by taking employers up on such opportunities when they're available. There's always something to learn. Even if some information doesn't offer immediate benefits, the education may prove useful at some point.

Life is full of opportunities, and Entertainers have a major advantage over other personality types when it comes to mastering different techniques and leveraging them in unexpected circumstances. It may be helpful to keep in mind that no matter what Entertainers do, they're constantly gaining experience and perspective and then filing it away for some later practical application.

Regardless of whether they're employed or not, they might explore learning opportunities loosely connected to their main specialization.

Plenty of subject areas utilize Entertainers' tactical thinking and risk management skills. Extending their interests can be an easy way to open new horizons while boosting self-confidence. Taking a skill-broadening class doesn't necessarily require formal admissions qualifications or prerequisites – nowadays, finding independent study material and programs is easier than ever.

If they have an opportunity, they may also want to try a hobby with income-generating potential. This approach is common among Entertainers, especially those already in stable and well-paid jobs that fail to meet their standards for excitement. Taking risks is almost second nature to them. The actual earnings from such hobbies may not matter to them initially, but the chance to do something that inspires and stimulates them may be worth it.

Independent Agents

Entertainers tend only to be satisfied with their career path when they feel confident they have enough freedom to do things their way. These individuals want others to see them as smart, artistic, and audacious. They feel restless if they're restrained by various rules or can't see the results of their work immediately. Unlike some other personality types, Entertainers always push themselves to the limits of their professional environment, regardless of the reward. They do it simply for the thrill of the chase.

Ultimately, everything depends on the flexibility of their place of employment. Few career paths are unsuitable for Entertainers, but there are plenty of positions that might underutilize their primary skills. If they're in jobs that are incompatible with their personality and needs, the gnawing feeling of being in the wrong place is unlikely to pass. Entertainers aspire to be masters of their fate, utilizing all resources (including other people's skills and connections) to enable them to achieve specific goals.

Front-Line Leaders

Finally, Entertainers fare well in situations requiring they do unfamiliar work under time pressures, and they tend to feel comfortable

deciding matters on the go and taking risks where others would falter. As front-line soldiers, Entertainers have excellent leadership skills lurking beneath the surface. This trait can supercharge their careers if they're in the right places at the right time. Entertainers should keep their eyes open if the organizations they're working for are prone to experiencing unexpected turbulence occasionally.

Career Options for Entertainers

A Few Ideas

This section looks at some specific jobs that Entertainers may find fit them best, but it isn't an attempt to provide a full list of professions. As the world welcomes new and different career options almost daily, it would be impossible to provide a comprehensive collection of job choices. The sampling below is a list of occupations compatible with Entertainer personality traits and added explanations. It can be used as a guideline by Entertainers thinking about their own career goals.

For those who are already employed, this may serve as a confirmation or an explanation for why they might be happy or unhappy in their current positions. However, this section is in no way intended to be a firm prescription of what Entertainers must do to succeed or be happy.

Business and Sales

Entertainers hold many qualities that fit perfectly with many business careers. They're practical yet also willing to take risks. They're friendly, smooth, and persuasive. And Entertainers have a natural flair for

storytelling, which makes "branding" come easily to them. People with this personality type also seek the new and innovative, which puts them on the cutting edge and is a strength in a competitive business field.

Overall, Entertainers work well with others and are popular, and this makes them excellent in commerce and business. As entrepreneurs, they're powerful networkers, a useful skill when building a business. Some possible business positions for Entertainers to consider are listed here.

- Insurance sales
- Investment banking
- Entrepreneur
- Personal money management
- Real estate
- Nonprofit fundraising
- Strategic planning
- Sales of any kind
- Advertising and public relations
- Event management

Presentation

With their charisma and storytelling skills, Entertainers make outstanding spokespeople who can leverage their gifts to represent a brand. People with this personality type are master communicators. They embrace interesting and new ideas and can use them to capture the imagination of their audience, whether in an advertising pitch or a boardroom meeting.

Entertainers can be witty, inspirational, and quick on their feet. Even the most scripted presentation sometimes needs improvisation, and Entertainers are naturals at creating spontaneous material. The effective and the unique interest them more than anything traditional

or expected, which helps Entertainer speakers who must prevent an audience from lapsing into boredom. Examples of some possible jobs are listed below.

- Actor
- Teacher
- Politician
- Public relations spokesperson or press agent
- Seminar facilitator
- Investigative reporter (broadcasting over publishing)
- Cleric (not too tradition-bound; missionary zeal over attachment to the liturgy)
- Lawyer
- Sales
- Motivational speaker

Practical Strategy and Coaching

To use an overworked phrase, Entertainers prefer "thinking outside of the box." This makes them outstanding strategists. This trait can be useful in business; however, Entertainers often use it in a coaching sense. They can apply this skill by helping individuals or groups of people move forward, especially when they're stuck.

When Entertainers combine their practicality with their love for shaking up the status quo, they can find unique ways to break bad habits and transform old patterns. Their genuine regard for others provides them with enthusiasm for this work. Here's a partial list of jobs where such skills might come in handy.

- Social worker
- Life coach
- Behavioral therapist

- Consultant
- Sports coach
- Nutritionist
- School guidance counselor

Challenging Career Aspects

In today's world, individuals not only spend a great deal of time at work, but they also tend to want their work to give them meaning. Entertainers must be careful not to get stuck in job situations that don't suit them, as they risk dealing with many difficulties when the roles they've chosen aren't a good fit.

Working Alone

Entertainers aren't likely to be comfortable in cubicles doing solitary work unless it involves phone sales or other outreach. Even then, they yearn for more solid human interaction. Isolated in a cubicle, working with lifeless data or paperwork is deadly to Entertainers. They need people, and they're often the ones in the front of the room leading and encouraging their teams. Energy from other humans nearly defines them on the job.

Mundane and Repetitive

Entertainer types crave activities that involve novelty and spontaneity. Repetitive work of any kind loses their interest and fails to meet their expectations. Unless they can use their improvisational skills, Entertainers become bored, so a level of unpredictability in their job description is nearly required.

Restrictive Environments

If their workplace structure and rules are too rigid, Entertainers feel stifled and unfulfilled. They like to experiment and explore new ideas. They're problem-solvers and innovators. When Entertainers can't exercise those passions, they're unhappy and may even lose their edge. Furthermore, people with this personality type are risk-takers, which others may frown upon in an office with an emphasis on rules.

Alternative Options

Self-Employment

Many people find self-employment scary. However, the days when someone spent twenty years working at the same company with ensured employment are over. Job security belongs to the past, except in specialized fields like the military or medicine. Working for oneself may be a more secure and viable option, which also comes with the ability to plan one's time, see the tangible results of one's own work, and be one's own boss. Entertainers value freedom and self-reliance and being self-employed gives them an opportunity to enjoy these qualities at work.

Self-employment can sidestep one of the major hurdles that Entertainers are likely to encounter in the corporate environment: forced compliance with numerous rules. As self-employed individuals, they may choose which tasks they want to perform and which they want to delegate or outsource. This self-determination can relieve them of any mundane administrative work. They can avoid following irrational orders they disagree with. Self-employment offers many major benefits to Entertainers, especially in today's global and always connected environment. People with this personality are likely to succeed as their own bosses.

Entrepreneurship

Entertainers are likely to feel comfortable creating their own businesses. Building an enterprise presents a risk – a challenge Entertainers are typically eager to take. Plenty of "entrepreneurs" give up because they fear jumping into a pool full of what they perceive as sharks, but Entertainers embrace risk and treat any negative consequences of taking them as just another challenge to meet. People with this personality type understand the life of the typical entrepreneur because they've been pursuing new and chancy things throughout their lives.

Without a suitable idea, however, no business can succeed. Entertainers who desire their own ventures must consider interesting ways to fulfill the existing needs of others (or create needs) and nail them better than their competitors. If they start with a strong concept, they're likely to manage the rest with ease.

Getting on the Career Ladder

Entertainers tend to be very adaptable. Even at school – often a source of frustration for many with this personality type – they're likely to improvise, experiment, and cope with daily challenges in ways that perplex and amaze others. Entertainers typically decide their actions on the spot and dislike planning and preparing for contingencies. Once they discover a niche that allows them the freedom to choose their preferred course of action or to manage and influence other people, though, Entertainers are unstoppable. The biggest challenge is in finding such opportunities.

Making Contact

Entertainers love socializing and networking. Their naturally social tendencies can enhance any job-hunting efforts, especially in tough job markets where their energy and outgoing nature can distinguish them from the herd. Entertainers typically possess a keen eye for detail, a solid grasp on reality, and the gift of persuasiveness. These skills can help them get their foot in the door.

Relating Outside Interests

Entertainers usually pursue many activities that they can add to their resumes or rely on during job interviews. Their hands-on approach is consistent in all that they do, so Entertainers likely have examples of activities that emphasize their skills and energy handy at all times.

Some activities that Entertainers who are entering the job market might use to enhance their applications could include volunteer work, community theater, competitions, local neighborhood initiatives, small businesses, or a web presence such as a blog or other relevant social media activity. Also, the more activities in their history, the more likely there is to be breathing space during interviews. Answering a question like, "Describe a situation where you've used your problem-solving skills," is much easier if there are plenty of real-life experiences to refer to in the answer.

As an example, citing acting skills alone won't be very useful if not accompanied by examples to share. Had they received accolades, like winning regional competitions, for instance, listing them on their CVs could be the deciding factor in landing the job. Interests and

experiences enthusiastically pursued says a lot about a candidate. Since passionate endeavors are hallmarks of Entertainers' lives, they're likely to give them an edge in interviews.

Preparing for the Interview

Entertainers may find it easy to show their prospective employers they're very dedicated, capable, and trustworthy. However, they may want to make sure they've covered all their bases before meeting with them. That probably won't be their first impulse. They should put aside their tendency to "wing it" and, instead, carefully plan which aspects of their lives they wish to put in the spotlight. By making this extra effort, they can present their skills in ways that thoroughly distinguish them from other candidates.

Entertainers may realize their strong social skills and enthusiasm consistently carry them through many situations. However, they shouldn't rely too heavily on these traits when interviewing for jobs. Being prepared is the key. Besides highlighting their experiences, it never hurts to prepare for common interview questions to avoid a surprise. Some interviewers find it easier to recite a standard list of uninspired questions, like, "What would you say is one of your weaknesses?" It would be a shame to lose opportunities because overconfident Entertainers hesitate too long on one of the basics.

Workplace Cooperation Between Types

It's useful to have something in common when working with someone else. Starting with a resounding "yes" rather than a stubborn "no" can make any conversation more productive. The following sections cover pairings of type groups, including brief overviews of potential synergies and obstacles, and some tips that may help Entertainers navigate these sometimes tricky waters.

Entertainer-Analyst Cooperation

Both Entertainers and Analysts enjoy the search for solutions, although their style and scope of doing so are different. If they recognize they're both seeking improved ways to accomplish goals, this commonality can make any discussions more productive. Should they grasp this concept early in their shared professional relationships and start to work together despite any differences in their approaches, they might realize that their motivations and objectives are fairly similar. Their desired outcomes may be more alike than is suggested at first glance.

Balanced Entertainer-Analyst Cooperation

Different Paths to the Same Goal

Entertainers focus on concrete, practical matters, while Analysts attend to overarching systems that favor the conceptual over the tangible. Analysts don't always see their ideas to the end. On the other hand, Entertainers often execute theirs swiftly – often failing to check in with others or get necessary permission. One is deliberative, but the other tends to be rash. For solving real-world problems, few outperform Entertainers. For understanding a system, deconstructing it, or building it better on paper, nobody matches Analysts.

When Entertainers and Analysts work together and become better acquainted, they may learn to collaborate, each contributing to a two-step process. Analysts can create their systemic models. Entertainers can follow up by expertly assembling the real-time, concrete pieces that make Analysts' prototypes work. Each has high-quality things to stir into the pot and Entertainers and Analysts who understand this can create powerful working relationships.

Consider *Apollo 13*, the movie and real-life event that brought us the iconic phrase, "Houston, we have a problem." After a mechanical mishap, three U.S. astronauts had to operate a crippled spacecraft, even while knowing they were in danger of not making it back to Earth alive. In this comparison, the Analysts would be ground control in Houston. They calculated the numbers, ran analyses, and worked out a trajectory that could get the astronauts home.

Clearly, the astronauts represent Entertainers. They were the problem-solvers doing the hands-on work and manipulating the details that brought about the swing around the Moon and eventually brought the capsule home. Communication between ground control (Analysts) and the astronauts (Entertainers) proved vital to the successful rescue. This metaphor loosely demonstrates how different functions and styles can collaborate to fulfill the same goal.

Unbalanced Entertainer-Analyst Cooperation

Diverse Focus

Initially, Entertainers might feel as if Analysts ignore important details and focus instead on vague, impractical ideas and hypothesizing. It can be tempting for Entertainers to dismiss Analysts as having their heads in the clouds and not understanding the practical side of, well, anything. In return, Analysts might judge Entertainers as reckless or narrow-minded. With such assessments, communication and collaboration may grind to a halt.

Analysts can be condescending if they don't feel someone is able to skillfully play in their playground of lofty notions and complex systems, and they may wrongly react to the focus Entertainers place on the concrete. They might simply write their practical colleagues off as uninspired. Meanwhile, Entertainers are just as likely to ignore Analysts' "intellectual nonsense" as they move ahead and complete the work. The result of discounting each other's value is that they both quit communicating with each other. That's a pitfall these coworkers may wish to avoid.

Rebalancing Entertainer-Analyst Cooperation

Sharing New Perspectives

Analysts become bored with too many minute details, but it doesn't mean they have no use for them. However, they don't feel the need to line up all the facts or dig into the minutia as their Entertainer coworkers do to gain an overview.

It's important for Entertainers to understand this and then call upon their Analysts coworkers to give them feedback from their unique perspective. It may surprise them at how a bigger picture focus can help them define the tasks they're doing and provide a richer, broader outlook. A new viewpoint might save them from going off course, especially if they habitually ignore their organizations' larger visions.

Entertainers may want to be careful and avoid dismissing Analysts and their theories too quickly. They should remember that, despite all their lofty ideas, Analysts want the same thing they do: the successful resolution of problems and challenges. Both are puzzle solvers, but each has a different technique. It may help communication if Entertainers learn to ask their Analyst coworkers more "why" questions.

Entertainer-Diplomat Cooperation

Entertainers, with their practical approach to life and problems, and Diplomats, with their more idealistic bent, seem likely to conflict with each other rather than cooperate. However, if, instead of thinking of these traits as opposing, they see them as complementary, there may be much potential for Entertainer-Diplomat cooperation. They quickly

find common ground when they tap into each other's passion and desire to bring about improvement. Idealism guided by realism can have profound results.

Balanced Entertainer-Diplomat Cooperation

Sharing Common Ground

The common ground between Entertainers and Diplomats is somewhat intangible, but they share similar attitudes. Both enjoy a sense of moving forward. Entertainers and Diplomats also both want to bring about change and improvement.

For Entertainers, this means finding novel, interesting solutions to specific problems. They can look at a tangled mess of a situation and figure out how to make it work – often in unique and fascinating ways. Diplomats, however, take a broader view involving personal growth, moral development, and well-being. They often flip a fixed social idea and create a new perspective.

Despite their differences, both types respect flexibility; rules and traditions don't bind either type too tightly. Entertainers are much more practical and utilitarian compared to Diplomats' idealistic pursuits of values, but it's easy to imagine them sharing a common appreciation for innovation and change.

Combining Vision with Craft

If Intuitive types and Observant types are open to each other's differences, partnerships between the two can blossom. Diplomats, as Intuitive types, grasp, create, and transform broad ideas. Details can bore Diplomats while they fascinate Entertainers. Entertainers manipulate each little piece of life's puzzles and use them to create something concrete and better. For "visions," call on Diplomats. For realizing these visions in practical, innovative ways, call on Entertainers.

As an illustration, suppose a Diplomat realizes that an organization must create a greater sense of community and camaraderie. Communication is poor. The Diplomat observes that interpersonal connections are almost nonexistent among their clients and coworkers.

An Entertainer might then step in to address this insight by creating an email newsletter, a phone chain, a podcast, monthly coffees, or lunchtime activities, for example. They would create a brand around the organization that says "community" and, in doing so, also create a team effort between the Diplomat and the Entertainer collaborators.

Unbalanced Entertainer-Diplomat Cooperation

A False Dichotomy

Established standards or rules bind neither Entertainers nor Diplomats as tightly as they might Sentinels. Nonetheless, Diplomats have unique codes by which they live. Their values – usually connected to their sense of empathy and compassion – are strong forces in their lives. Entertainers aren't amoral as a rule, but values aren't always as prominent in the ways they handle business.

For instance, Entertainers like people and are usually friendly, outgoing, and fun. However, occasionally, they may see solving a problem as more important than taking care of a colleague or addressing a client's feelings or general satisfaction. They may also take risks, cut corners, or cavalierly develop plans that might have a negative impact on others. Entertainers sometimes trust their instincts a little too much, doing something on their own without taking other people's opinions or standards into account. Such occasions might create conflicts between Entertainers and Diplomats.

The Doer and the Dreamer

Diplomats may see Entertainers as shallow, and Entertainers may regard Diplomats as impractical dreamers. Entertainers tend to live in the present while Diplomats live in the infinite time of imagination and thought. Diplomats are more likely concerned with long-range results while Entertainers show more interest in immediate actions and solutions.

Let's use a hospital metaphor here. Diplomats would be the case managers equipped to handle patients' long-term well-being and creating holistic treatment plans. Meanwhile, Entertainers are down in the emergency room doing triage and reattaching limbs. These two

views, distinct interests, and styles can create communication issues; however, someone running a hospital wants both types around to save lives in the long and short term.

Rebalancing Entertainer-Diplomat Cooperation

Discovering Motivations

If Entertainers want to discover what motivates Diplomats, they must learn about their values first. These coworkers are likely to extend their principles and ideals into their work lives as far as they reasonably can. The optimal way to communicate with them involves carefully limiting details or methods in the discussion. These things hold little interest for Diplomats, who prefer talking about broader ideas. To determine their common ground, Entertainers may want to begin with questions that start with, “What if?”

As with all pairings of distinct types, Entertainers and Diplomats work best together when they learn to appreciate their differences. There is an economy of personality types which suggests that learning how to relate to different types can create complementary and beneficial relationships. Each type potentially rounds out all other types. For Entertainers, this may mean paying attention to Diplomats when they share their values and humanistic insights. These insights and perspectives can potentially help Entertainers should they let outcomes become more important than other people.

Entertainer-Sentinel Cooperation

It's easy to get the impression that Sentinels and Entertainers are opposites. They often approach things differently, but they aren't without commonalities. They both prefer to gather information directly from the world around them instead of filtering it through internal mechanisms – abstract theories hold little interest for either of them. Entertainers are more in touch with things that are spontaneously evident, whereas Sentinels usually judge their experiences through the lens of tradition and are sticklers for rules and structures that support that perspective. Explorers relish the exciting; Sentinels favor the stable.

Balanced Entertainer-Sentinel Cooperation

Coming to the Rescue

Entertainers and Sentinels most often complement each other when things go wrong. In this modern world, outdated approaches often stop working. This can be disconcerting to predictability-loving Sentinels, but a compelling situation for Entertainers. They quickly embrace change and adapt to it speedily, and they can lend support to Sentinels as they adjust more slowly to the onslaught of progress.

Entertainers possess an impulsive drive to act and can easily veer off track when they "wing it" in search of new experiences and solutions. Sometimes, the best answer when a situation goes awry is to retreat to a known starting place. Sentinels like to spend their time in those places. They can help Entertainers "come home" when they've gone astray, figuratively speaking. Sentinels usually know how to repair a situation, or they know someone who does. This can come in handy when Entertainer colleagues wander too far off in the wrong direction.

Unbalanced Entertainer-Sentinel Cooperation

Clashing Styles

Certain things about Entertainers can drive Sentinels crazy. Entertainers usually go with the flow and don't allow others to bother them very much, so the dynamic is different for them. Sentinels, however, may find their problems with headstrong Entertainers fiercely disturbing.

Entertainers have no problem cutting corners when necessary, but Sentinels usually dedicate their lives to guaranteeing those corners remain intact – as they've always been. Sentinels prefer things to be orderly and predictable, whereas Entertainers have a freer attitude and love everything new and interesting. These differences can trigger tension and disagreement.

As a nonwork-related example of their different approaches, Sentinels might prefer a favorite restaurant they go to regularly, but Entertainers are more likely to sample all the latest dining experiences available in town. At work, Entertainers can seem reckless and unruly to their Sentinel coworkers. In turn, they might perceive their Sentinels colleagues as boring and bland. These opinions of each other are usually more reactionary stereotypes than accurate assessments, but such impressions can hinder trust and open communication.

Varied Regard for the Status Quo

Keeping the status quo strongly in place is essential to Sentinels, but their Entertainer coworkers have little problem disregarding "how it's always been done" and doing whatever they deem necessary to solve a problem, no matter how unconventional. For Sentinels, the tried-and-true leads to a stable, predictable end. Entertainers only want a successful outcome, and they aren't always picky about the means they take to get there.

Sentinels may view Entertainers as being at cross purposes with them. They may devote a massive amount of time trying to persuade Entertainers to walk in a straight, rules-based line. Meanwhile, Entertainers often ignore these Sentinels and do whatever they feel they must do, whether that's walking in a straight line, a serpentine

line, or any other direction that helps them master a situation. The possibilities for conflicts between the two are nearly endless.

Rebalancing Entertainer-Sentinel Cooperation

The Value of Protocols

Poet and philosopher George Santayana wrote, "Those who cannot remember the past are condemned to repeat it." Entertainers might be too quick to dismiss Sentinels' attachment to the past and settled protocols, as much can be learned from their adherence to tradition and set standards. Entertainers shouldn't be afraid to ask why they should do something in a particular fashion. Meanwhile, Sentinels may want to avoid answering and justifying an act or decision by saying anything that resembles, "Because we've always done it that way."

Mutual Learning

For Entertainers, accepting Sentinels' counsel may help avoid problems. Entertainers may feel Sentinels somehow limit their options. It may even be true, but it's unlikely that Entertainers will permanently lose their spontaneity and edgy creativity if they play by the rules occasionally. Relying on their Sentinel coworkers' sensitivities to the rules and standards may help them stay around in a job to create another day.

When their counsel proves to be sound, Entertainers should take a moment to acknowledge their Sentinel friends. Sentinels may never ask for it, but they're always happy when someone shows appreciation. Doing so may be a way to create stronger work relationships between Entertainers and Sentinels.

Entertainer-Explorer Cooperation

Entertainers and their fellow Explorers typically find themselves "speaking the same language." Theoretical and conceptual problems, which thrill Analysts, are annoying to both. Conversations about solving problems or mastering skills or situations are of greater interest. People with these personality types gain boldness and further motivation from acting, and there's likely a lot of energy around Entertainer and Explorer colleagues. People with these personality types relish conversations that reveal how they overcame a problem and saved the day.

Balanced Entertainer-Explorer Cooperation

Whatever Gets the Job Done

When working together, Entertainers and other Explorer types want to discover the best way to do the job, and they may bypass rules, standards, or traditions that hinder their focus and strategies. Because of this spontaneity and independence, others often view them as risk-takers.

Together, Entertainer and Explorer colleagues may enjoy discussing the new and the different if these discussions focus on tangible matters. They're unlikely to stray into the arena of abstract theories. They might appreciate talking about the capabilities of the new iPhone but show less interest in a discussion of "the sociological impact of constant digital communications worldwide," for example. They might share a sense of satisfaction if they figure out a unique use for the phone, dismissing discussion of its global implications as "just talk."

Practical Innovation

Entertainers and Explorers brought together as a team are likely to become a brainstorming powerhouse. They'd resolve problems, innovate, and add to their company's growth – but only as it affects practical methods. The harnessed energy of Entertainers and other Explorers who bounce ideas off each other would be an asset to any organization. Entertainer and Explorer coworkers are likely to make their joint discoveries on the run and are more likely to do it by applying their hands to the problem rather than drawing out diagrams and steps on a whiteboard.

Unbalanced Entertainer-Explorer Cooperation

When Entertainers and other Explorer types talk to each other, they have no trouble finding common ground and mutual understanding. As a result, though, they may become stuck in their thinking style and lose the benefit of insight from those who think differently. In business and life, it's good to have varied personality types around to give balance.

But at What Cost?

On the off chance that work becomes too "Explorer-heavy," there are several factors that can be problematic. To illustrate this, consider Grace Hopper, the late computer scientist and United States Navy Rear Admiral who famously said, "It's much easier to apologize than to get permission." Entertainers and other Explorers often take this quote to heart and then end up in hot water as a result. Their willingness to take risks and follow different paths to find unique solutions can be an asset in the workplace; however, this risk-taking tendency shouldn't go unchecked.

The often complex relationship of Entertainers and their fellow Explorers with their coworkers may need tempering. While they typically enjoy other people, they often put practical solutions ahead of the feelings and concerns of others, often coming across as having a brusque disregard for their coworkers. It's not that they don't like their colleagues, but they do tend to place people below solutions on

their list of priorities. "It can't be helped" would be the excuse shared between an Entertainer and his Explorer accomplice – if they even discussed such matters.

Solutions with a Small Perspective

Entertainers and Explorers might also find their actions don't align with the larger vision of an organization. Because both types are detail-oriented and think in the present, they may disregard the big sky view of a company's overall objectives and focus. Just as it takes only one degree of a compass to send a ship hundreds of miles off course, a small, misguided solution can disrupt a company's larger goals.

The immediacy of the Explorer mindset can potentially create the kind of tunnel vision that ignores greater matters if not adjusted for and kept in check. Even if other Explorers think Entertainers are offering reasonable solutions, their supervisors may believe they're thumbing their noses at the vision and values of their company.

Rebalancing Entertainer-Explorer Cooperation

Appreciate Commonalities

When Entertainers and Explorers work together, they may want to take advantage of their camaraderie and enjoy their time together by brainstorming new and better ways of doing things. Entertainer and Explorer coworkers likely already enjoy simply spending time talking to each other, but the experience goes up a notch if they find something to tinker with while they're chatting.

Getting a Second Opinion

When two types are so similar and comfortable with each other's great ideas, a second opinion from someone with a more "mainstream" perspective might be useful. Every personality type can benefit from the balance provided by other types. Even Entertainers and their Explorer teammates can grow as individuals and as colleagues when they expand their comfort zones by exploring different approaches.

Asking "Why?"

Entertainers and Explorers who work together may find that they're quite comfortable exploring the "how" questions involved in finding a solution. To rebalance their efforts and keep the relationship beneficial, learning to ask "why" may be just as essential. This may again require a second opinion from someone who's more in touch with the bigger picture.

Conclusion

Entertainers need to exercise their independence and must feel autonomous. This is essential to their happiness and motivates them to produce and succeed. If a job presents only overstructured conformity that demands unskilled behaviors, Entertainers won't be able to access that part of themselves that responds in healthy ways to challenges.

To thrive in a job, Entertainers must find a niche of their own. Most are good at this, having practiced it while dealing with school systems focused on more conventional things than they, as young people, could relate to. While not always good at commitment in any traditional sense, once they find their niche, they're usually all in for the duration. This allows them to become highly skilled and often specialized – making them valued workers and professionals in many fields.

Final Words

"All the world's a stage," Shakespeare once wrote. Entertainers embrace this philosophy quite literally, especially when it comes to their academic and professional careers. Comfortable working with the public, these high-energy individuals are always "on." Their energy rarely winds down when they're doing something that they are truly passionate about. Entertainers live for the moment, and their presence can make even the stalest of workplaces feel fresh. Cataloging their signature qualities, it's easy to paint Entertainers as frivolous, flighty, or even irresponsible – but who could resist their idea that life, and the work that one does, are both better when they include a measure of lightheartedness?

But then there's the inevitable flip side of the coin – the more mundane side – which Entertainers often neglect. Offsetting the sometimes impulsive ingenuity that they bring to their work with the less exciting responsibility of meeting their obligations is a challenge that they wrestle with constantly. Learning how to do this without losing their unique qualities is a balance that Entertainers must achieve if they are to grow and flourish, both academically and in their chosen career.

School and work are not always thrilling. Entertainers will inevitably be faced with less-than-inspiring tasks and assignments, as well as teachers and colleagues who resist even the merest suggestion of taking a risk and doing something differently. For people with this personality type to reach their full academic and professional potential, they'll need to learn how to harness their passion and stay motivated, even when their to-do list doesn't satisfy their craving for novelty and excitement.

In these pages, we've discussed how Entertainers can draw on their gifts and overcome common obstacles as they go after their academic and professional goals. Our hope is that these insights will help Entertainers make progress toward their version of success without sacrificing the sense of fun and excitement that they crave in their lives. With their bold improvisational skills and their ability to adapt to whatever the present moment calls for, Entertainers who lean into their strengths and work through their challenges can grow into exactly the movers and shakers that this world so desperately needs.

So... What's Next?

You've reached the end of this book, but fear not – we've created many more resources for you. Here are a few that might capture your interest:

- Want more tests and insights to help you excel in your career? Explore our Career Specialized Tests.
- Looking to enhance your relationships? Check out the *Entertainer Guide to Relationships*.
- Ready to build a strong foundation for your self-development? Our *Entertainer Guide to Personal Growth* may be just what you need.

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